STORMDOM

Global Storm Tracker



Tropical Storm DUJUAN Tracker

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1. TYPHOON 24W (DUJUAN) WARNING NR 024
   AT 4:00 PM TROPICAL CYCLONE IN NORTHWESTERN
   PHILIPPINE SEA MOVING NORTHWARD AT 10 KNOTS AWAY
   FROM MAINLAND CHINA
   WARNING POSITION:
      SATURDAY 03 SEP 2022 0000 UTC...29.1N 139.0E
      MOVEMENT PAST SIX HOURS - 000 DEGREES AT 10 KTS
      POSITION ACCURATE WITHIN 15 NAUTICAL MILES
      POSITION BASED ON CENTER LOCATION BY A COMBINATION
      SATELLITE AND RADAR
   MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS - 105 KT, GUSTS 085 KT
   WIND RADII VALID OVER OPEN WATER ONLY
      150 NM SOUTHEAST QUADRANT
      090 NM SOUTHWEST QUADRANT
      090 NM NORTHEAST QUADRANT
      090 NM NORTHWEST QUADRANT
   RADIUS OF 050 KT WINDS - 090 NM SOUTHEAST QUADRANT
                            060 NM SOUTHWEST QUADRANT
                            060 NM NORTHEAST QUADRANT
                            060 NM NORTHWEST QUADRANT
   RADIUS OF 034 KT WINDS - 170 NM SOUTHEAST QUADRANT
                            120 NM SOUTHWEST QUADRANT
                            120 NM NORTHEAST QUADRANT
                            120 NM NORTHWEST QUADRANT
   REPEAT POSITION: 33.7N 138.8E
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Tropical Storm FAY Tracker

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Tropical Storm Fay Advisory Number  8
NWS National Hurricane Center Miami FL       AL062026
900 AM AST Mon Sep 21 2026

...FAY BEGINS TO WEAKEN...

SUMMARY OF 900 AM AST...0000 UTC...INFORMATION

LOCATION...32.3N 52.3W
ABOUT 1150 MI...1850 KM E OF BERMUDA
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...40 MPH...65 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NE OR 035 DEGREES AT 12 MPH...20 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...1004 MB...29.65 INCHES
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Tropical Storm ODALYS Tracker

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Tropical Storm Odalys Advisory Number  5
NWS National Hurricane Center Miami FL       EP162026
200 AM PDT Mon Sep 21 2026

...ODALYS CONTINUES MOVING NORTHWESTWARD...

SUMMARY OF 200 AM PDT...0900 UTC...INFORMATION

LOCATION...13.5N 128.7W
ABOUT 1100 MI...1770 KM SW OF THE SOUTHERN TIP OF BAJA
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...65 MPH...75 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NW OR 310 DEGREES AT 9 MPH...15 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...1004 MB...29.65 INCHES
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Tropical Depression 17E Tracker

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Tropical Storm Pola Advisory Number  9
NWS National Hurricane Center Miami FL       EP172026
500 AM CDT Mon Sep 21 2026

...POLA EXPECTED TO RAPIDLY INTENSIFY...
...TROPICAL STORM WATCH ISSUED FOR A PORTION OF SOUTHWE
MEXICO...

SUMMARY OF 300 AM CDT...0800 UTC...INFORMATION

LOCATION...15.3N 102.8W
ABOUT 245 MI...395 KM S OF MANZANILLO MEXICO
ABOUT 265 MI...425 KM SSE OF PUERTO VALLARTA MEXICO
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...40 MPH...75 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NE OR 50 DEGREES AT 8 MPH...13 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...1002 MB...29.62 INCHES
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See my new article: *How I Met Hurricane Camille*

What Is a Hurricane?

A hurricane (or typhoon, or severe tropical cyclone), the strongest storm on Earth, is a cyclonic (rotary) storm that derives its energy from evaporated ocean water and, unlike frontal storms, usually travels over water.

A hurricane begins as a tropical depression with a sustained wind speed of less than 39 mph (35 knots, 63 km/h). As the system strengthens, it becomes a tropical storm with winds from 39 to 73 mph (35-63 knots; 63-118 km/h). Tropical storms are named in the Atlantic, East, Central and Northwest Pacific, in the South Indian Ocean, and in the Arabian Sea. When the winds are sustained (based on a one-minute average) at 74 mph (64 knots; 119 km/h), the storm becomes: In the Atlantic Ocean, East Pacific, Central Pacific (east of the International Dateline) and Southeast Pacific (east of 160°E) a **Hurricane**; in the Northwest Pacific, west of the International Dateline) a **Typhoon**; in the Southwest Pacific (west of 160°E) and Southeast Indian Ocean (east of 90°E) a **Severe Tropical Cyclone**; in the North Indian Ocean a **Severe Cyclonic Storm**; and in the Southwest Indian Ocean (west of 90°E) a **Tropical Cyclone**.

The Saffir-Simpson Hurricane Scale

Category 1 – 64-82 knots (74-95 mph; 119-153 km/h). Damage is limited to foliage, signage, unanchored boats and mobile homes. There is no significant damage to buildings. The main threat to life and property is flooding from heavy rains.

Category 2 – 83-95 knots (96-110 mph; 154-177 km/h). Roof damage to buildings. Doors and windows damaged. Mobile homes severely damaged. Piers damaged by storm surge. Some trees blown down, more extensive limb damage.

Category 3 – 96-112 knots (111-129 mph; 178-208 km/h). Major Hurricane. Structural damage to some buildings. Mobile homes are completely destroyed. Roof damage is common. Storm surge begins to cause significant damage in beaches and harbors, with small buildings destroyed.

Category 4 – 113-136 knots (130-156 mph; 209-251 km/h). Structural failure of some buildings. Complete roof failures on many buildings. Extreme storm surge damage and flooding. Severe coastal erosion, with permanent changes to the coastal landscape not induced by Hurricane force winds extend well inland.

Category 5 – 137+ knots (157+ mph; 252+ km/h). Complete roof failure on many buildings. Many buildings destroyed, or structurally damaged beyond repair. Catastrophic storm surge damage. In the Northwest Pacific, a typhoon that reaches 130 mph (241 km/h) is called a Super Typhoon.

SAFFIR-SIMPSON SCALE

Category	Knots	MPH	KM/H	Damage
1	64-82	74-95	119-153	Minimal
2	83-95	96-110	154-177	Moderate
3	96-112	111-129	178-208	Extensive
4	113-136	130-156	209-251	Extreme
Super Typhoon	130+	150+	241+	Catastrophic
5	137+	157+	252+	Catastrophic

Storm Surge

Historically, storm surge is the primary killer in hurricanes. The exact storm surge in any given area will be determined by how quickly the water depth increases offshore. In deep-water environments, such as the Hawaiian islands, storm surge will be enhanced by the rapidly decreasing ocean depth as the wind-driven surge approaches the coast. The peak storm surge is usually to the right-front quadrant (left-front in the Southern Hemisphere) of the eyewall at landfall, where on-shore winds are the strongest, and at the leading edge of the eyewall. Contrary to a frontal storm surge, which lasts for hours while wind-driven water is pushed by the storm's winds, storm surge comes in waves. Another factor in the severity of the storm surge is tide. Obviously, an 18-foot storm surge at high tide is that much worse than an 18-foot surge at low tide.

Tropical Cyclone Formation

By Jonathan Edwards

Tropical Cyclone Genesis is the technical term for the process of storm formation that leads ultimately to what are called hurricanes, typhoons, or tropical cyclones in various parts of the world.

Tropical cyclones require a source of heat energy, the Intertropical Convergence Zone, or ITCZ, shifts northward out of the doldrums and atmospheric conditions become favorable for tropical cyclone formation after about the middle of May.

A series of low-pressure ripples develops within the ITCZ. These are known as tropical waves and progress from east to west. In the late season, these typically shift their movement toward the west-northwest or northwest as the subtropical ridge builds westward.

These tropical waves, ideally embedded in the deep-layer easterly flow, contain a northeast wind shift. This is typically referred to as a "convergence", where lines of equal atmospheric pressure are pressed together between the high-pressure ridge to the north and the low-pressure system. The convergence is amplifying in every layer as it is evacuated up through the developing eyewall and out by the tropical wave approaches. Gusts up to 25 mph may occur. Sometimes there can be gusts to tropical storm force in stronger waves. There can be a circulation but only helps clear the eye, but can also produce a feature known as the "moat", which is an area of relatively weak convection outside the core of the tropical cyclone. The combination of eye and moat can make the storm's core look like a doughnut. The eye can have a diameter anywhere from 10 to 40 miles across.

When the wave passes over warmer waters (SSTs), convection and resulting rainfall are enhanced. This greater rainfall is concentrated with the low-level circulation center. By the time these pressures fall to 1000mb, it is likely that the northeast wind has closed off to a southwest wind on the backside of the wave. The low-level circulation center is now complete. The moat now completes the closure on the northern side of a broad low-level center, and a tropical depression has formed.

We often hear that a tropical depression has formed, but conditions are unfavorable for further development. There are two conditions that must be present for the tropical depression to continue its development: warm SSTs (above 79° Fahrenheit/26° Celsius) and low vertical shear. A tropical cyclone derives its power from the warm waters below. In addition, a strong entocyclone directly above the low-level inflow is favorable. As a tropical cyclone is pulling in warm, moist air at the surface, it must also evacuate this inbound flow aloft. This occurs in the upper levels of the atmosphere, where high pressure is present. The combination of low pressure at the surface and high pressure aloft is favorable for tropical cyclone development. The high pressure aloft helps clear the eye, but can also produce a feature known as the "moat", which is an area of relatively weak convection outside the core of the tropical cyclone. The combination of eye and moat can make the storm's core look like a doughnut. The eye can have a diameter anywhere from 10 to 40 miles across.

If the upper-level high pressure system does not remain over the cyclone, it means there is shear ahead. This is a strong jet of air that is blowing directly over the cyclone, ripping the cloud tops off the deep convection. This has the effect of breaking down the whole mechanism. This is known as vertical shear. Vertical shear usually comes from a westerly or southerly direction, and can occur if the cyclone is located in an unfavorable position near a cold front or upper-level low pressure system. Another factor that can interfere with the development of a tropical cyclone is subsidence. Subsidence is the sinking of air. This happens on the edge of an upper-level high-pressure system. Subsiding air has the effect of suppressing thunderstorm formation. This also is why a tropical storm that tries to form near an established hurricane has a very difficult time—the cyclone is on the edge of the hurricane's upper-level outflow, and may have to contend with both subsidence and shear.

The center of what we call a cyclone can range from a failure to develop further to catastrophic collapse of the tropical cyclone's vapor structure.

Tropical cyclones have the low-level circulation and the upper-level circulation (outflow), whose formation was discussed above. There is also a mid-level circulation. The mid-level circulation is similar as structure to the low-level circulation, and is critical to the survival of a tropical cyclone. Sometimes the mid-level and the low-level circulation can be severely disrupted, or even dissipated, by interaction with land, especially mountainous terrain. If the mid-level circulation remains intact, the cyclone can regenerate rapidly when it reemerges over water, provided other factors are favorable.

Assuming all the ingredients are in place—warm SSTs, upper-level high pressure, and falling surface pressures—the cyclone will develop and reach a point of rapid intensification. It is one of nature's perfect machines. As warm waters heat the convection that ascends to the upper levels of the troposphere, and falling surface pressures, high pressure aloft evacuates the inflow, which intensifies the inflow of warm, moist air, which in turns increases the rainfall and brings about a more rapid fall in central pressure.

Eye formation begins when a tropical storm reaches approximately 65mph, provided conditions are favorable for strengthening to continue. The eyewall begins to make its appearance, usually on the eastern (Northern Hemisphere) edge of the center. As the storm becomes better organized and

stronger, the center contracts from about 200 miles across to roughly 90 miles at this stage. An increase in rotational velocity accompanies the smaller, more defined center. The inflow is speeding up even more as it is evacuated up through the developing eyewall and out by the high pressure outflow structure. The eye begins to appear as a clear spot in the center, as the air here is sinking. The eyewall creates turbulence and not only helps clear the eye, but can also produce a feature known as the "moat", which is an area of relatively weak convection outside the core of the tropical cyclone. The combination of eye and moat can make the storm's core look like a doughnut. The eye can have a diameter anywhere from 10 to 40 miles across.

Tropical cyclones can exhibit a great deal of durability provided that the upper level support remains and the southerly (Northern Hemisphere), or tropical, inflow is present. Here are some examples: In 1998, Hurricane Mitch developed into a supersaturne Category 5 hurricane. Nevertheless weakening began when the center moved to a position directly north of Honduras, cutting off the southerly inflow from even though the eye was still over a hundred miles offshore. Later, Mitch maintained its mid-level core against all odds over the mountains of Honduras. Because the mid-level circulation did not interact from the East Pacific. Reintensification to tropical storm strength was slowed immediate after reaching the Bay of Campeche. In 1988 Gilbert hit the Yucatan near Cancún as a Category 5 hurricane. The Yucatan mountains, though flat, extended far enough south through the critical southerly inflow zone that Gilbert never recovered, even after moving over the open waters of the western Gulf of Mexico. Contrast this with the northern Gulf coast and numerous examples from Camille to Elena and beyond, where the proximity of the eye to land is not necessarily a weakening factor, although the extensive shelf water can sometimes cause a storm to undergo strong storm generated enough significant convection to create hurricane force winds. Examples of this are Severe Tropical Cyclone Monica, which developed into a "super cyclone" just north of Australia. The northerly (equatorward) inflow over the Arafura Sea fed this storm.

What are the factors that contribute to the decay of a tropical cyclone? They are Upwelling, Entraining dry air, Moving over cool waters, Exposure to upper-level westerlies, and finally Landfall.

Upwelling. When a hurricane stalls, its movement is his fallen below 5mph, or its movement is erratic over a small area, the wave action caused by the strong surface winds churns the ocean surface and produces upwelling. This has the effect of cooling the temperature of the sea surface over an area 200 to 300 miles across. The result is weakening. It is possible for a hurricane to stall in one area long enough that it dissipates. In 2004, Hurricane Frances stalled off the southeast Florida coast long enough that the core of the hurricane collapsed. Frances eventually made landfall as a Category 1 hurricane, instead of the earlier expected Category 3.

Entraining dry air. Sometimes, during the peak season, when tropical cyclones approach continental land masses, they may entrain dry air as a part of their interaction with frontal troughs that carry cool, dry air behind them. The dry air kills off the convection that drives the hurricane's engine. If the dry air entrains deeply enough, the result can be dissipation.

Moving over cool water. Similar to upwelling, when a tropical cyclone moves over cool water (below 77° Fahrenheit/25° Celsius), it begins to weaken. Eventually this causes dissipation, particularly in the East Pacific. In the Atlantic, if the storm is caught in the mid-latitude westerlies and begins to recurve to the northeast, it generally becomes an extratropical storm by the time it has reached about 45° N. This is the so-called "graveyard" of the Atlantic. The storm becomes extratropical when it has interaction with a cold front, baroclinically driven storm system, and eventually becomes a gale in the north Atlantic, or is absorbed by a large gale. There have been times when a hurricane passes north of the Azores and hits the British Isles as a Force 8 or even gale, having retained its characteristics.

Exposure to upper-level westerlies. Frequently, the ridge of high pressure that keeps the hurricane heading toward the west erodes. In the Atlantic Ocean, this may result in strong upper-level westerlies diving down and impinging on the northern edge of the hurricane's upper-level outflow. When this occurs, the hurricane can weaken but still maintain itself when outflow is restricted in one quadrant. If outflow becomes too restricted, resulting shear can disrupted the inner core.

After landfall. Tropical cyclones cannot survive over land, once their access to warm SST is removed. A powerful hurricane, such as Hugo, which hit Charleston, S.C., in 1989 can project life-threatening hurricane force winds over two hundred miles inland. As the storm progresses inland, it can dump a huge amount of rain—sometimes measured in feet. The storm may evolve into a frontal cyclone that continues to cause widespread damage, but the main example of this is Hurricane Camille in 1969, whose center hurricane force winds to make landfall on the continental United States with winds sustained at 190 mph and gusts well exceeding 200 mph—which roared up the Mississippi Valley and eventually ended up in Canada as a powerful extratropical storm strength as far as Manitoba. Hurricane Agnes in 1972 made landfall in Florida as strength rapidly after landfall, reaching tropical depression strength by 48 to 72 hours. The main threat with the gravy storm is from tornadoes and flooding. Hurricane Agnes in 1972 produced a tornado outbreak in Pennsylvania. In the Northern Hemisphere, to the right of the center is the most frequently the strong side of the storm. This is because the forward motion is added to the counter-clockwise punch of the storm. Thus, the right-hand side of the hurricane contains the strong on-shore flow. This is where the maximum storm surge flooding, and the greatest potential loss of life, will be experienced. After landfall, the circulation's motion over land causes a great deal of turbulence, which results in tornadoes. These are usually weak EF0 to EF1 tornadoes, but can be strong EF2 tornadoes.

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